



The Hierophant

The Book of Flames

The Hierophant's Codex for Seven-Part Pact

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Part I: The Hierophant

Behold the **Hierophant**, known as Keeper of the Flames, Grail-Bearer, and The Blessed Lord of Hope. He is the caretaker of the immortal flames burning within the temples of Isha, and through this authority, cares for the common folk of the archipelago and their faith in the Gods. He is oft of a jovial and determined temperament, and his fate is governed by the planet Jupiter and the metal Tin. It is said the first Hierophant was deemed unworthy by his peers, and it was only through the fury of the common people that his signature was placed upon the Pact.

Within this Part of *The Book of Flames*, you will be prompted with a number of choices to make on behalf of your wizard.

Humour & Temperament

Determine your Elements by making choices about your wizard's personality and experiences. Should his answers ever change, adjust his Elements accordingly.

The monks of the temples care for the minds, bodies, and souls of the people of Isha. Would you rather they...

- ☐ Prioritize study, scripture, and seclusion? (+1 Fire)
- ☐ focus entirely on charity, compassion, and care? (+1 Water)

Your time is valuable, and there are always yet more people knocking on your door and asking for your help. Do you...

- ☐ Overburden yourself to help others? (+1 Water)
- ☐ Reserve your magic for your own business? (+1 Air)

As a prominent figure within Isha, you are often prompted to give speeches to reassure the public. Do you approach such moments with...

- ☐ Rousing and passionate fervor? (+1 Fire)
- ☐ Cautiously and quietly, feeling out of place? (+1 Air)

A massive disaster recently struck a major port town, killing hundreds. As Hierophant, the people of Isha looked to you for help. Did you...

- ☐ Command the churches to provide charity and aid for the populace? (+1 Earth)
- ☐ Take charge of cleaning up the mess yourself, and fumble under the expectation? (+1 Water)

The Immortal Flames are a living miracle, a proof of the power of the god Ithax. When you look deep inside your heart, do you...

- ☐ Fully believe in the glory of Ithax? (+1 Fire)
- ☐ Find there is no faith within yourself? (+1 Earth)

The people of Isha are tired, sickly, worn-down by years of famine and oppression and disease. Truthfully, do you see them as...

- ☐ A noble people beaten down? (+1 *Earth*)
 - ☐ Disgusting cretins lost to ignorance? (+1 *Air*)
-

The true form of your fragment of the Seven-Part Pact is a grail, but tradition demands that in your hands it takes another form:

- ☐ A sturdy staff bearing a spark of the sacred flame within a lantern. (+1 *Fire*)
- ☐ A beautiful harp carved with the musculature of the fire-bringer Ithax. (+1 *Air*)
- ☐ A warm ring emblazoned with the symbols of the temples along its curve. (+1 *Earth*)
- ☐ A golden goblet engraved with the legends of the birth of the Isha archipelago. (+1 *Water*)

You have a familiar who accompanies you in your magic, and who rests in your bag while you traverse Isha. They are:

- ☐ A tabby cat, with beautiful eyes and soft paws. (+1 *Fire*)
- ☐ A soaring pigeon, with colorful feathers and sharp eyes. (+1 *Air*)
- ☐ A tiny brown dog, with a long body and a yapping bark. (+1 *Earth*)
- ☐ A soft rabbit, with floppy ears and a twitching nose. (+1 *Water*)
- ☐ Any other animal, nervous and frayed from proximity to the Flame. (+1 *to an Element of your choice*)

History & Secrets

There was another Wizard before you, your old master who taught you the secrets of theurgy, and in many ways was a father for you. How did he teach you, and what became of him?

Choose 1 which is known to all and 1 which you harbor in secret.

- ☐ He was a kindly man, the heart of the city itself, and he taught you to care for others with limitless patience. He died in his sleep, a rare and just way for a good man to die.
- ☐ He was a pious man, who gave himself body and soul to the flames, and taught you to do as well. He was betrayed by another Wizard (perhaps by the old Faustian).

- ☐ He was an eccentric fellow, overwhelmed by his obligations, who preferred to teach you how to garden and mend. He fled Isha one day, never to be found again, and you hope he found some isolated island where he can spend his final days in peace.
- ☐ He was a heretic, who drunkenly railed against the Church and the Immortal Flame, and dreamed of other faiths and other truths. When the Pontifex figured out his schemes, he was quietly disposed of.
- ☐ He was a greedy man, who taught you how to play the church and the people against one another to make a quick buck and pilfer their coffers. He died as he lived — choking on his own wealth.
- ☐ You never met the former Hierophant, as you were chosen by the church and the Pact working together to fill a vacant seat. He taught you still, in flickering visions within the immortal flame.
- ☐ You learned your magic in the dusty halls and black beaches of sacred Tahv and amongst the monks of the Temple Hestar, and needed no master to guide you in the art of theurgy.

The one scarcity all Wizards share is time. Wizards discuss their age in scores, periods of twenty years that shape their long and wizened lives. How old are you, and what is expected of you in your age?

- ☐ You are just a boy, far too young to assume the mantle of Hierophant, but the immortal flames chose you and forced you to become who you are.
- ☐ You are a young fellow, not yet two scores old, and the monks of Hestar treat you as a student, piling on endless scripture for you to memorize and research.
- ☐ You are of a middling age, between two and three scores old, and it is expected for you to have found a wife and to have fathered at least one child.
- ☐ You are of a proper age, between three and four scores old, and it is expected for you to have fathered many children, and indeed to be a grandfather for some.
- ☐ You are of a great age, between four and five scores old, and it is expected for you to be Isha's patriarch, the grandfather of a great clan, and for half of Isha to call you elder.
- ☐ You are at least a century old, and it is expected for you to lose yourself in your age, and to depend upon your doting family to transport you through Isha, who are eager to take away your agency.

- ☐ You are far more than a century old, and you are treated as a living relic of a bygone age, an object to be revered and presented in ceremony, no longer viewed as a person but instead an idol of faith.

Magic changes those who work with it. Choose 1 change, and another 1 for every score you've been alive:

- ☐ Multiple sets of white wings unfurl from your back, and if you wish to hide them you must bind them with rope.
- ☐ Upon being cut, your body does not produce blood but instead fresh wine.
- ☐ Your feet no longer touch the ground, and you float wherever you go.
- ☐ You can feel the pain and intense emotions of those near you, and their suffering digs into your heart.
- ☐ Your skin glows like a candle at all times of day, and you leave ash upon whatever you touch.
- ☐ A hundred languages both known and extinct wind their letters along your body, spelling out countless sacred truths in your skin.
- ☐ Cobblestones and mosaics settle into your feet, and the small creatures of the Blue City treat you as an extension of the streets, climbing into your hair and along your body.
- ☐ When you speak as a Wizard, your voice is not alone, but instead echoes with countless other voices in a haunting chorus.
- ☐ Whisps of incense and smoke billow from your body, and slowly fill any room you step into with dense fumes.
- ☐ Your chest has been hollowed out, and where your organs once were, candles and shrines now rest.
- ☐ Your body can withstand tremendous, agonizing pain, the sort which would kill another man.
- ☐ Additional eyes protrude from your skin, and through them you see glimpses of other worlds and other times.
- ☐ You no longer sleep, but instead enter into periods of deep meditation, during which many may assume your body is dead.
- ☐ You are always crying.

You are a man, as all Wizards are. However within your heart you know:

- ☐ To be a man is to carry the weight of the world alone, and your body is giving out underneath you, and you cannot support everyone anymore.
- ☐ To be a man is to stand up for what is right, and your role is composed of countless compromises and moments of moral weakness.
- ☐ To think of yourself as a father or grandfather makes your stomach churn, and you cannot be a man to those you love.
- ☐ You live a double life as a woman, a poorly-kept and shameful secret for the people of Isha, and the subject of mockery from those who despise Wizards.
- ☐ You were once a woman, but the church forced you to be a man so that you could further their agenda within the Pact.
- ☐ The immortal flames have burnt away all that once gendered you, and what remains is hardly a man at all.
- ☐ There is an even greater secret, which is for you and you alone.

Your name as a Wizard within the Seven-Part Pact is:

- ☐ A name taken from scripture or mythology.
- ☐ A title bestowed upon you by the Pontifex of the temples.
- ☐ An honorific prophesied by the Immortal Flames.
- ☐ A nickname granted by the common folk of Isha.

Might & Trappings

Through your Pact-Fragment, you may freely perform any of the following:

- During the Initiation of a spell, transform any two instances of the symbol "𐌒" (Jupiter) into any Glyph (*with the exceptions of* "☉" Sol *or* "𐌗" Sulfur).
- During the Initiation of a spell, interpret the presence of "☾" (Salt) as "𐌒" (Jupiter).
- Perform the liturgical rites of the Temple calendars, demonstrate to the people the importance of faith, and perform the other listed functions of your Domain as revealed in *Part III: The Temples of the Flame* on page XXXX.

Along with your Pact-Fragment, you possess 3 of the following Treasures. Pick which ones your old master left for you, which the Church gifted you with, and which you recovered yourself:

- ☐ A long trumpet carved from a shell, which bellows with all the fury and sound of the storm, and can be heard across the archipelago, calling upon the people of Isha to act in the defense of their home.
- ☐ A canteen filled with holy water, which when poured over wounds, heals them, and when poured over the dying, brings comfort.
- ☐ A simple dagger stained red from generations of ritual sacrifice before the sacred flames, before the practice was outlawed in Isha.
- ☐ A hefty two-handed mace, inlaid with countless sparkling gems, which was once the favored weapon of the first Hierophant, all those generations ago.
- ☐ A set of bowls made from carved seashells, said to have been the vessels of the god Ephris before he departed this world, and which produce warm water for tea.
- ☐ A pewter medallion depicting a wild hare, the sacred animal of Ithax. When kissed, the hare will come to life and follow your commands until it returns to the medallion.
- ☐ One of the original scrolls carrying the wisdom of the 2nd Prophet, written in a dense script on fragile papyrus.

Additionally, you are adept at the secret practices of theurgy, which grant you access to certain Humble Magics, cantrips which you may perform at any time through your will and without any incantation. They include:

- Transform loose stones and shells into breads and cheeses, or the base of a stew, enough to satisfy hunger or bring relief to the starving.
- Grow the brightness of all nearby sources of light, scattering shadows, startling foes, or amplifying candles, and raising your voice to be heard across a crowd.
- With one turn or stroke of your pact-fragment, make fresh water pour forth; two turns, valuable gems and pearls; three turns, a comforting hearth; four turns, a bolt of lightning.

Finally, you carry the following possessions:

- A woolen orange cloak, with tin clasps bearing the symbol of Jupiter.
- Three sets of clothes, at least: suitable for a priest, a well-off but down to earth gentleman, or an itinerant pilgrim on the streets of Isha.
- Any materials necessary for the casting of magic, such as: herbs, potions, twine, stones, etc.
- Any accessibility aids or mobility tools, such as: a cane, a wheelchair, painkillers, etc.

- This very Codex, filled with the notes of Hierophants past.

Part II: The House outside the Blue City

In the heavy and venerated relic of the past the Hierophant labors, surrounded by those few he feels safe enough to trust. It is a busy and exhausting life, here at the heart of Isha, but it is the seat of power for the Blessed Lord of Hope, and all know to pay their respects when they walk past his home.

Within this Part of *The Book of Flames*, you will be prompted with a number of choices to make about your wizard's Isle, Sanctum, and Companions.

Companions

While your wizard is powerful, he is also mortal, and as a mortal, he requires care from others to survive. Each Element is associated with the ways his Companions care for him.

- His **Earth Companion** cares for his daily life, ensuring his Sanctum stays organized, the bureaucracy of the Orthodoxy is kept up with, and that his food each day is warm and well-prepared.
- His **Water Companion** cares for his emotional life, comforting him when he's scared, giving physical intimacy and touch, and that the burdens of Hierophant do not weigh down his heart.
- His **Air Companion** cares for his private life, guarding the House from waves of pilgrims and anti-magus revolutionaries, protecting his secrets shared in confidence, ensuring he can find privacy away from your responsibilities.
- His **Fire Companion** cares for his creative life, providing conversation late into the night, philosophical musings on the nature of gods and faith, and inspiration for the further development of his magical practice.

Choose four Companions, with at least 1 Companion who lives alongside the Hierophant and at least 1 who dwells amongst the people of Isha, determine the answer to their question, and assign each to care for a particular Element:

- ☐ Your prentice, who must serve as Hierophant when you die. *What light from the Immortal Flame lingers in your Prentice's heart?*
- ☐ Your wife, who burns with a faith far deeper than yours. *What promise did the two of you make, which you will never break?*
- ☐ Your son, naive to the importance of the Flame. *Why does your son rebel against your teachings?*
- ☐ Your daughter, kept sheltered away from the commonfolk. *What affliction are you convinced she suffers from?*
- ☐ Your sibling, who grew up alongside you amongst the monks. *Why does your sibling still look down upon you?*
- ☐ Your best friend, who doesn't care about your office or authority. *How did he save you when you were at your lowest?*
- ☐ Your elder, close to death but still no less wise. *In what ways does your elder still see you as a child?*
- ☐ Your fellow monks, who keep to the monastery at your side. *How do your monks devote themselves to you?*
- ☐ Your angel, the spiritual guardian of the temples. *What expectation does your Angel place upon your shoulders?*

Should one of your wizard's Companions ever depart, die, or become unwilling to take care of their Element, he must do so himself. Each month he must spend Time providing this missing care, perhaps through constant and self-destructive prayer, reneging against the morality of the faith, or wielding power over the weak and vulnerable. Until he does so, the associated Element will be reduced to 0 for the duration of the month.

Ishana

Secrets of Ishana

Ishana is the core of the archipelago, a series of closely-related islands with a shared culture and history. You may spend Time upon your Map to care for your Isle, and in doing so, change or add further to its Lore.

- Ishana is a central mountainous island surrounded by up to fifty smaller islands, ranging from just large enough to support a single home to a sprawling landscape in its own right.
- The center of Ishana is The Blue City, named for the brilliantly blue shingles and lapis lazuli paints which decorate nearly every building in the city, alongside murals of the seas and skies.
- The northern forests of Ishana are an important source of lumber for constructing new ships, and an especially vulnerable region to the pirates of Scuttleport.
- The Chalk Cliffs of Ishana, which run along its eastern face, are home to goatherders, farmers, and hermits, and legends tell of forbidden religions practiced in those isolated communities.
- The southernmost island of Ishana is the sacred isle Tahv, a place of black beaches and a thousand shrines, and welcome only to those permitted in the light of the Immortal Flame.

The Hierophant's Hall sits at the edge of Ishana and serves as your private Sanctum from the outside world. You may spend Time upon your Map to care for your Sanctum, and in doing so, change or add to its Lore further.

- The sanctum of the Hierophant is narrow and cramped, with winding staircases and cramped halls.
- The walls are covered in visual signs of the eccentricities of previous Hierophants, from sweat and blood to prophecies carved into the stone, and it is considered blasphemy to even suggest cleaning them.
- The Hall is only accessible via a small waterlogged path that floods at high tide, which leaves it both beautiful and frustratingly hard to travel to.

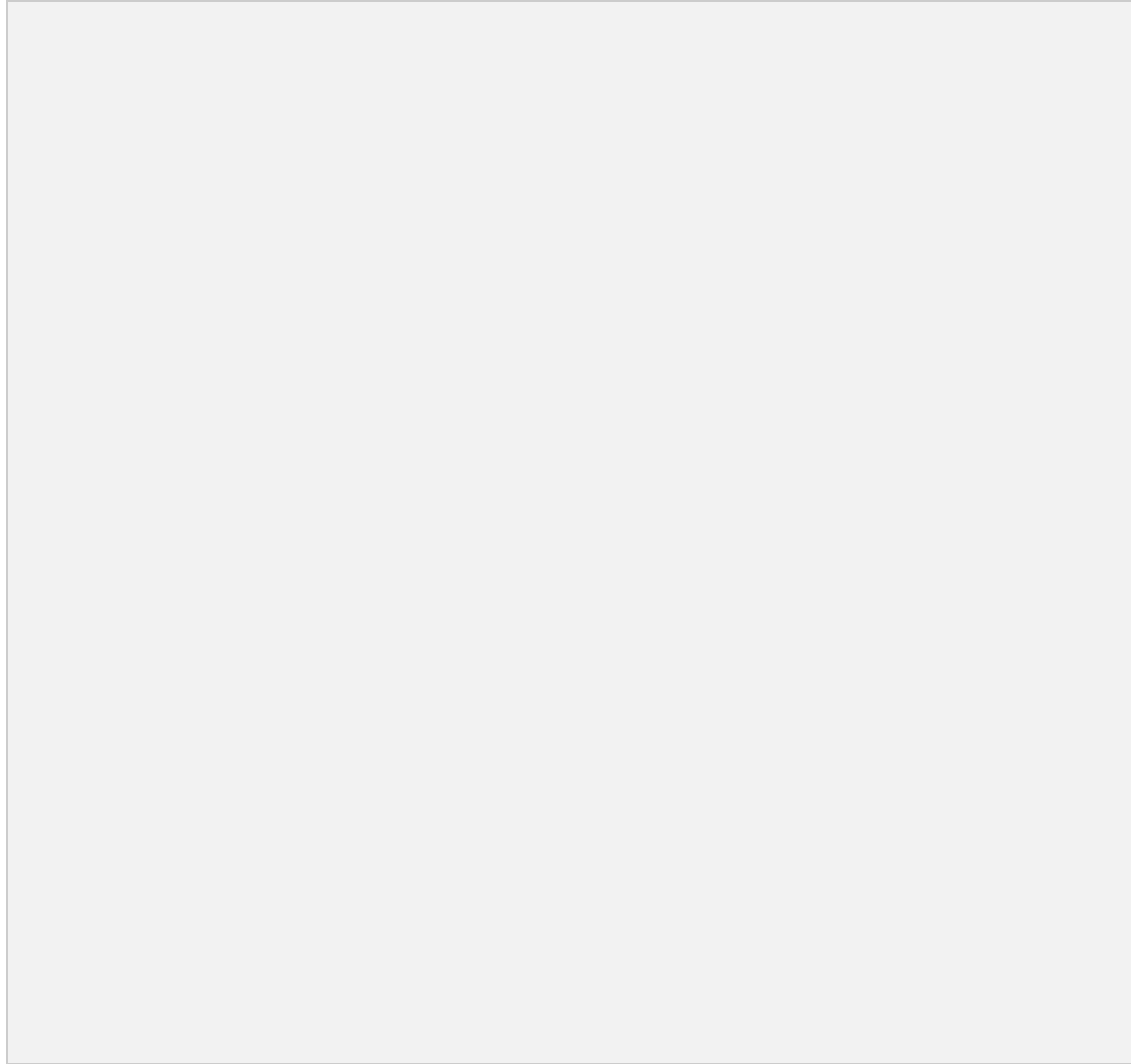
- Pilgrims are constantly coming by to request miracles and assistance with whatever minor problem is beleaguering them on their journeys.
- No one has mapped the sanctum's basement, its tangled stairways connecting with the catacombs beneath Ishana, and strange monsters rattle down there at night.

Map of the Blue City

Whenever you have a spare moment, complete and mark the map of the Blue City. It should include some or all of the following details:

- The Hierophant's Hall.
- The fish markets and the farmer's markets.
- The Temple Krolis, the largest Temple in Isha.
- The viceroy's palatial estate.
- The memorial to a past wizard's violence.
- Where the poor are forbidden.
- Where the wealthy are unwelcome.
- All your favorite places to sit and rest.

[description: A map of the coastline of Western Ishana, with a compass rose and arrows pointing "to Scuttleport, Far Reach," "to the Halcyon Isles," "to Sacred Tahv."]



Part III: The Immortal Flame

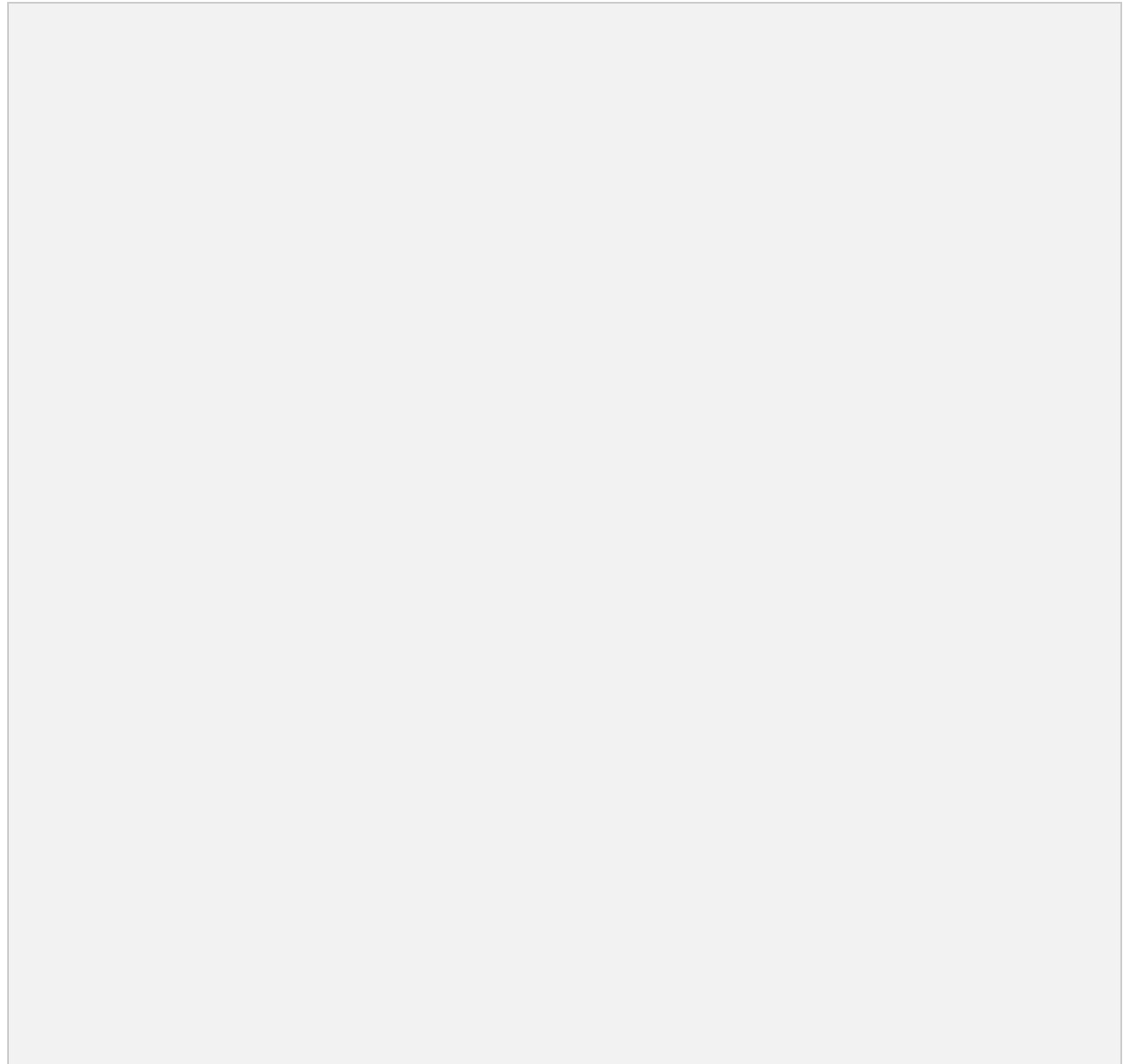
When the fire-god Ithax descended from the heavens with fire in his hands, he brought light to the people of Isha. His flame still burns today in five temples across the Archipelago. These Temples are places of religious devotion, but they also serve as centers of community, sites of celebration, and safehavens for the outcast. In the flickering of the temples, the future and the past can be found, and every day thousands of pilgrims travel from across the world to pay their

respects to the true proof of divinity. The temples are the centers of Isha's people, and to maintain them requires caring for all the people of Isha.

Within this Part of *The Book of Flames*, you will learn about the operations of the Temples, the liturgy and devotion of its populace, and the blasphemy which ferments at its core. This section will cover rules for distributing aid, celebrating holidays, and what to look for each month as the stars change within the sky.

Entering the Temples

[description: Four large concentric circles arranged in a square with a fifth smaller circle in the middle. Each are labeled with a different Temple and where that Temple is located: Temple Krolis in the Blue City, Temple Notor in Scuttleport, Temple Zephon on the Chalk Cliffs, Temple Ushin in Caravesse. The fifth circle in the middle is labeled Temple Hestar on Sacred Tahv. For each of the larger circles, the outside circle is labeled "Courtyard" and the interior circle is labeled "Agiary."]



The Immortal Flame has been carefully tended for ages, its presence a warding light against darkness and a comfort for the people of the archipelago. There are five such flames, each one guarded by its priesthood, united in its shared devotion to the teachings of the prophets and the tutelage of the fire god Ithax.

- **Hestar** is the oldest temple, guarded from visitors and forbidden to the uninitiated.
- **Krolis** is the largest temple, at the center of the bustling metropolis of Ishana.
- **Notor** is the most charitable temple, deep in the slums of Scuttleport.
- **Zephon** is the most remote temple, at the farthest edge of the Chalk Cliffs.
- **Ushin** is the wealthiest temple, overlooking the venerated shipyards of Caravesse.

Each Temple (save Hestar) is architecturally divided into two areas: a **Courtyard** where the general public may revere the Immortal Flame from a distance, and an **Agiary** where the heart and soul of the Temple's community may congregate.

Refer to *Part VI: Secrets of Faith — The Immortal Flame* on page XXXX to learn more about each Temple.

The Laws of the Flame

Choose 2 which must be followed by all who step foot within a Temple of Isha:

- ☐ Thou shalt not spill blood here, or allow even a single drop to touch the ground.
- ☐ Thou shalt not speak with a voice above a whisper here, or yell within the temple.
- ☐ Thou shalt not depict others as images here, or represent the divine as human.
- ☐ Thou shalt not enter the temples without ritually bathing and breathing incense.
- ☐ Thou shalt not perform magic here, or allow magic to occur near the flame.
- ☐ Thou shalt not judge another here, no matter their crimes.
- ☐ Thou shalt not bring coins here, or allow any wealth to enter.

Consequences for failing to follow the Laws of the Flame while within a Temple can be found in *Part IV: Watcher to the Flame — Mob Justice* on page XXXX.

Rules of the Temples

Abundance, Conviction, & Doctrine

Each Temple has two resources which constantly fluctuate over time. A Temple's **Abundance** is a measure of the Temple's wealth, spiritual authority, and social sway over the archipelago. A Temple's **Conviction** is a measure of the monks' sturdiness in faith, Doctrine, and orthodoxy.

Temples also have their **Doctrine**, a statement of ideology that informs who will seek comfort from that Temple. You may schedule Time on any Temple to give a public sermon about the Orthodoxy. Spend that Time to replace its Doctrine with any other Doctrine. Then, remove either 1 Abundance or 1 Conviction from the Temple for each Supplicant.

If a Temple would lose Abundance, but it lacks Abundance to spend, the Temple **Collapses** (see page XXXX).

If a Temple would lose Conviction, but it lacks Conviction to spend, it changes its Doctrine to be **Blasphemous** (see page XXXX).

Doctrine

Orthodox Doctrine	Blasphemous Doctrine	Supports
"The nobility are born to shepherd the world."	"The nobility have the right to do as they please."	<i>Gentry</i>
"A good life is the sign of a pious believer."	"Take everything from everyone, plunder the world."	<i>Merchants</i>
"One's dedication is proven through one's skill at their craft."	"Society must be continuously destroyed and remade."	<i>Artisans</i>
"Everyone is subservient to the will of the gods."	"Kill everyone who thinks they're better than you."	<i>Peasants</i>
"All are born equal in the light of the flame."	"The past will serve as kindling for the fire of our new world."	<i>Pariahs</i>
"The wealthy deserve the pleasures of their station."	"Indulge your every sumptuous, exotic, and twisted desire."	<i>Gentry, Merchants</i>
"The flame shines warmly on dreamers and artists."	"Enlightenment can be found through opiates and toxins."	<i>Gentry, Artisans</i>
"Family is most important above all."	"Destroy the false and arrogant tools of man."	<i>Gentry, Peasants</i>
"Charity is the measure of moral worth."	"There is no law but the law of the wolf."	<i>Gentry, Pariahs</i>
"The church has no authority over the will of the King."	"The accumulation of individual wealth is all that matters."	<i>Merchants, Artisans</i>
"Compassion is a sign of nobility and respect."	"To take a life is to take your own."	<i>Merchants, Pariahs</i>
"One's worth is proved through one's labor."	"The old land demands the blood of the idle."	<i>Artisans, Peasants</i>
"People used to be kinder to each other."	"We must destroy all trappings of modernity."	<i>Peasants, Pariahs</i>
"Everyone is born into their proper role."	"Burn the criminal, the witch, and the exile."	<i>Gentry, Merchants, Artisans</i>
"We are masters of our own destiny."	"Enemies on all sides seek to take what's rightfully yours."	<i>Merchants, Artisans, Peasants</i>
"Wealth corrupts the hearts of men."	"One must abandon all earthly desires in pursuit of wisdom."	<i>Artisans, Peasants, Pariahs</i>

Temple Hestar

Temple Hestar is the center of the Pyretic Orthodoxy, located on the Sacred Isle of Tahv, whose black sands are forbidden for any save the most blessed members of the clergy to step foot upon. Temple Hestar functions differently than the other Temples in Isha. Supplicants will not naturally appear there (although as Hierophant you may bring them there) and it lacks any set Doctrine. Instead, its Doctrine supports everyone. [footnote: Should Temple Hestar ever change its laws on access or orthodoxy, these rules themselves change.]

If Temple Hestar lacks Abundance or Conviction, it may instead remove Abundance or Conviction from any other Temple. If another Temple lacks Abundance or Conviction, it may instead remove Abundance or Conviction from Temple Hestar.

Schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on Temple Hestar to provide for the Temples. Spend that Time to remove any amount of Conviction from any combination of **non-Blasphemous** Temples and place that same amount of Abundance on Temple Hestar, or remove any amount of Abundance and place that much Conviction.

Supplicants, Classes, Woe, & Benefaction

Supplicants are people traveling to the Temples seeking wisdom and guidance. They are each from one of the five **Classes** of Isha. These Classes demand either Abundance or Conviction from their Temple.

- **The Pariahs** encompass lepers, outlaws, the dying, and anyone else with nowhere else to go. They lack any wealth but are the most devoted and faithful to the Orthodoxy's teachings. *Pariah Supplicants cost a Temple 2 Abundance.*
- **The Peasants** are the vast majority of Ishanians, who labor in fields, tend to fisheries, and earn a meager income doing backbreaking physical labor for sustenance. *Peasant Supplicants cost a Temple 1 Abundance.*
- **The Artisans** encompass craftsmen, masons, seamstresses, and other creators. They tend to be more educated and have access to more wealth. *Artisan Supplicants cost a Temple 1 Abundance or Conviction, whichever is more plentiful.*
- **The Merchants** encompass traders, bankers, landlords, and other peddlers of wealth. They have access to far more wealth than the general Populace, but seek out religion that reinforces their laissez-faire morality. *Merchant Supplicants cost a Temple 1 Conviction.*

- **The Gentry** encompasses the lords and ladies of the aristocracy of Isha. They have access to enormous wealth for their sites of worship, at the cost of vainglorious self-insertion. *Gentry Supplicants cost a Temple 2 Conviction.*

Supplicants can only receive support from Temples whose Doctrine **Supports** their Class. Each Supplicant has an amount of **Woe**, a measurement of the quantity of care they need from the Temples. During the Visions Phase of each month, each Supplicant at a Temple whose Doctrine Supports their Class costs the Temple the associated Abundance or Conviction, then removes 1 Woe. Otherwise, they gain 1 Woe. If a Supplicant ever gains 5 or more Woe, they'll depart the Temple and seek a **Cult** who can support them instead (page XXXX).

You may schedule Time on a Supplicant to help steer them in the right direction. Spend that Time to move them to any Temple, including Temple Hestar, then remove 1 Woe from them.

Benefaction

If the last Woe is removed from a Supplicant, they depart the Temple, and give the Temple a **Benefaction** to show their support. The size of the Benefaction is determined by their Class.

- **Gentry**: +4 Abundance
- **Merchant**: +2 Abundance
- **Artisan**: +1 Abundance
- **Peasant**: +1 Conviction
- **Pariah**: +2 Conviction

Prophets

Prophets are mortal servants of the Pyretic Orthodoxy who have obtained visions from staring into the Immortal Flames. Prophets are rare and tremendously venerated by the Temples, but are also incredibly dangerous in the wrong hands.

Whenever a Temple with a Reliable Prophet would produce Abundance or Conviction, the Prophet's presence causes them to gain an additional +1 Abundance or Conviction.

If the Prophet's Temple's Doctrine changes, the Prophet will leave the Temple behind and become Disruptive. Create a new Cult in any other wizard's Domain and flip the Temple's former Doctrine to Blasphemous to represent this (page XXXX).

More information on Prophets is in *Part V: Denizens of the Flames* on page XXXX.

False Doctrine & Collapse

Blasphemous Ideology

A Temple whose Doctrine has become Blasphemous no longer shares its Doctrine with the Pyretic Orthodoxy. No one can spend Time there to celebrate Holidays or change its Doctrine. It cannot share Abundance or Conviction with Temple Hestar. At the start of each month, if it lacks Conviction, create a Complication for any other wizard from the false doctrine spreading throughout Isha. If the Temple Collapses, it instead becomes a Cult in any other wizard's Domain.

Cults

A Cult is another religious practice which explicitly rebukes the Temple Orthodoxy. They take shelter in other Domains and anchor themselves there. Cults amass Abundance and Conviction and use this to subvert and supplant the Orthodoxy, asserting their own faith instead. Cults extract these resources from their Domain, creating Complications for other wizards as a result. Cults are covered in detail in *Part V: Denizens of the Flame*, page XXXX.

The Temple's Collapse

A Temple Collapses when it no longer has the resources to maintain its infrastructure, to feed and house the monks who live there, or keep up with necessary maintenance. When a Temple Collapses, its Immortal Flame is extinguished and it is no longer a holy site. Flip the Temple's Board over.

- *If the Temple had any Supplicants*, take the Temple's Doctrine, flip it over to be Blasphemous, then create a Cult in any other Domain. Then move any Supplicants onto appropriate Cults. This Cult represents the false ideology that has sprung up among its adherents in the absence of the Immortal Flame. Give each other Wizard a Complication related to this Cult.
- *If the Temple lacked Supplicants*, it has simply been forgotten. Remove its Doctrine. If any Supplicants would be placed on it, place them on appropriate Cults instead.

If Temple Hestar should ever Collapse, or its Doctrine would become Blasphemous, the Pyretic Orthodoxy as it is understood collapses, and the Hierophant's entire Domain is undone.

Holidays and Feast Days

The myths and stories of the Pyretic Orthodox reverberate through time. Both creation myths and apocalyptica, the rhythms of the gods and the prophets are reflected in the yearly cycle of **Holidays** celebrated by the people of Isha. While all of Isha celebrates these Holidays, they are centered at a particular Temple. While a Temple's Holiday is celebrated, its Congregants are more adoring and eager to support their faith.

During the Visions Phase of each month, determine the current Holidays based on the Liturgical Calendar and place **Holiday Markers** on the associated Temples. Schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on a Holiday Marker to officiate that Holiday for that Temple. Spend that Time to receive each Petitioner's Benefaction.

Certain Holidays are **Feast Days**, special periods of intense celebration across all of Isha. When these occur, place a Holiday Marker on every Temple, including Temple Hestar.

You may Schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on any Temple with a Holiday to prepare the celebrations there. Spend that Time for the Temple to receive each Supplicant's Benefaction, and describe how you celebrate the Holiday at that Temple.

The Liturgical Calendar

Month	Holiday Name	Associated Temple	Description
January	Week of Lights	Krolis	Week of ten thousand candles, parties in the street across Ishana. Considered the start of the new year by the common folk of Isha.
February	The Serpent's Parade	Notor	Celebrate the gods' slaying of Ymos, with giant snake floats paraded through the slums.
	Endnight	Zephon	The coldest night of the year, stories of the end of the world, many climb up to the Chalk Cliffs to watch the night sky.
March	Brother's Day	Feast Day	Commemorates the discovery of Ithax upon the

Month	Holiday Name	Associated Temple	Description
			iceberg by his brother Ephris. Celebrated with lots of alcohol, elaborate costumes, and wrestling and duels amongst men.
April	Saint Innocent's Day	Ushin	The first prophet's death-day, honored with bouquets of flowers, lapel pins, and extravagant ceremonies reaffirming the King's divine mandate.
May	Galetide	Zephon	Honoring the four winds, giant woodwind instruments built to play music through nature.
	Hangman's Day	Notor	Venerating the patron prophet of thieves and gamblers with fake gold coins, miscreancy, and carousing.
June	Midsummer Festival	Feast Day	Commemorates the creation of life by the two brother-gods. Celebrated with various animal costumes, pageantry, and parades through the streets.
July	Triumpart	Ushin	The clans each race their finest ship through the bay, the winner ceremonially "marries" the prophet Cassine.
August	Old Api's Fair	Krolis	Sheep-worshipping festival, mutton, wool, and fine wine across Ishana.
	Ambolas	Zephon	Pilgrims traverse the Chalk Cliffs to honor the path walked by the Teacher Edon in his quest to keep the Orthodoxy safe from the violence of the Tragedies.
September	Harvest-End	Feast Day	Commemorates Ithax's ascent to the heavens to steal fire for mankind, and the shooting star he rode back down to earth. Celebrated with bonfires, picnics, and fire-tossing.
October	Goblin Night	Krolis	Scarecrows are dressed up as goblins and demons to scare off the unwelcome dead.
November	Mournival	Notor	Grieving for the Tragedies and those who have died,

Month	Holiday Name	Associated Temple	Description
			families going on pilgrimages to the Graven Isle to leave offerings there.
	Debutante	Ushin	Fancy masquerades, bonfires, and elaborate balls held amongst the noble Clans.
December	Midwinter Banquet	<i>Feast Day</i>	Commemorates the gifts of fire, magic, and invention brought to mankind by Ithax. Celebrated with candles, lots of feasting, and ice-skating across the Bay of Ishana.

Summary of the Flame [box]

During the Visions Phase...

1. For each Supplicant in a Temple whose Doctrine supports their Class, remove an amount of either Abundance or Conviction from the Temple and they take -1 Woe. Otherwise they each take +1 Woe.
2. For each Supplicant who gains Woe this way, if they now have at least 5 Woe, they leave the Temples and join a Cult (page XXXX).
3. Consult the Orrery in reference to *Watching The Stars* on page XXXX to determine the Liturgical Calendar and how it impacts the Temples.
 - a. Place a Holiday Marker on each Temple celebrating.

Remember...

- Temple Hestar's Doctrine supports all Classes. Supplicants will not appear there normally, but they may be moved there. If a Temple lacks Abundance or Conviction, they may spend from Temple Hestar's supply instead.
- When the last Woe is removed from a Supplicant, they depart the Temple and give Benefaction based on their Class.
- If a Temple lacks Abundance, and it's asked to spend more, it Collapses (page XXXX). If it lacks Conviction, and it's asked to spend more, its Doctrine becomes Blasphemous (page XXXX).

You may...

- Schedule Time on any Temple to give a public sermon about the Orthodoxy. Spend that Time to replace its Doctrine with any other Doctrine. Remove either 1 Abundance or Conviction for each Supplicant at the Temple.
- Schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on a Temple with a Holiday to prepare the celebrations there. Spend that Time to receive each Supplicant's Benefaction.
- Schedule Time on a Supplicant to help steer them in the right direction. Spend that Time to move them to any Temple, including Temple Hestar, then remove 1 Woe from them.
- Schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on Temple Hestar to provide for the Temples. Spend that Time to remove any amount of Conviction from any combination of non-Blasphemous Temples and place half as much Abundance on Temple Hestar, or remove any amount of Abundance and place half as much Conviction.

Watching The Stars

To ascertain the behavior of the Temples and the actions of the citizens of Isha, determine the current month by the placement of **The Sun** (☉). Use this to determine the current Holiday or Holidays being celebrated across Isha, and inform the Celestial Audience. Place a Holiday Marker on each Temple celebrating. If it's a Feast Day, place a Holiday Marker on *every* Temple. Look to the Planets in conjunction **The Sun** (☉) to determine the nature of the Holiday and the behavior of the Populace.

If **Mercury** (☿) and **The Sun** (☉) are in conjunction, the Temples are in need of repair. Each Temple takes -1 Abundance. If any Temple has no Abundance, it instead gains a random Supplicant and takes -1 Conviction.

If **Venus** (♀) and **The Sun** (☉) are in conjunction, a new Supplicant arrives at the Temples, looking for guidance and advice. Choose each Temple tied for the fewest Supplicants (besides Temple Hestar) and roll a D6, adding a Supplicant with three Woe based on the result. If ☐ (*Salt*) is rolled, add a Gentry. If ♃ (*Jupiter*) is rolled, add a Peasant. If ♂ (*Mars*) is rolled, add an Artisan. If ♀ (*Venus*) is rolled, add a Merchant.

If **Mars** (♂) and **The Sun** (☉) are in conjunction, violence and conflict brings a Supplicant to the Temples, someone whose life has been marred by war. Choose each Temple tied for the least Abundance (besides Temple Hestar) and roll a D6, adding a Supplicant with four Woe based on the result. If ☐ (*Salt*) is rolled, add a Pariah. If ♃ (*Jupiter*) is rolled, add a Peasant. If ♂ (*Mars*) is rolled, add an Artisan. If ♀ (*Venus*) is rolled, add a Merchant.

If **Jupiter** (♃) and **The Sun** (☉) are in conjunction, the populace look to the Flames for guidance. Each Temple with a Holiday Marker takes -2 Conviction. **If it is a Feast Day**, then create a new Prophet at any Temple with the most Conviction.

If **Saturn** (♄) and **The Sun** (☉) are in conjunction, the populaces flood the Temple, seeking respite from the chaos of the outside world. Choose each Temple tied for the most Abundance (besides Temple Hestar) and roll a D6, adding a Supplicant with four Woe based on the result. If ☾ (Salt) is rolled, add a Pariah. If ♃ (Jupiter) is rolled, add a Peasant. If ♂ (Mars) is rolled, add an Artisan. If ♀ (Venus) is rolled, add a Merchant.

If **The Sun** (☉) lies alone, with no other Celestial Bodies within its Houses, the Temples reflect and re-evaluate their Doctrine. Each Temple tied for the lowest Conviction must change its Doctrine to any random other Doctrine.

Arranging The Temples

No Matter What:

1. Place the following Doctrines and resources on the Temples:
 - a. Temple Krolis: 5 Abundance, 4 Conviction, "One's worth is proved through one's labor."
 - b. Temple Notor: 3 Abundance, 6 Conviction, "Charity is the measure of moral worth."
 - c. Temple Zephon: 4 Abundance, 5 Conviction, "People used to be kinder to each other."
 - d. Temple Ushin: 5 Abundance, 4 Conviction, "The wealthy deserve the pleasures of their station."
 - e. Temple Hestar: 4 Abundance, 5 Conviction.

Quiet Arrangement

[description: The Temples of Isha, arranged according to the instructions below.]

To prepare the Temples for a Quiet Arrangement, perform the following actions:

2. Create a Gentry Petitioner with two Woe and place them at Temple Ushin.
3. Create an Artisan Petitioner with three Woe and place them at Temple Krolis.
4. Create a Pariah Petitioner with four Woe and place them at Temple Notor.

Dynamic Arrangement

[description: The Temples of Isha, arranged according to the instructions below.]

To prepare the Temples for a Dynamic Arrangement, perform the following actions:

1. Create a Prophet and place them at any Temple.
2. Create a Gentry Petitioner with two Woe and place them at any other Temple.
3. Create a Peasant Petitioner with three Woe and place them at any Temple not yet chosen.
4. Create two Pariah Petitioners with four Woe each and place them each at a different Temple.

Explosive Arrangement

[description: The Temples of Isha, arranged according to the instructions below.]

To prepare the Temples for an Explosive Arrangement, perform the following actions:

1. Create a Prophet and place them at any Temple.
2. Create a Merchant Petitioner with two Woe and place them at any other Temple.
3. Create a Peasant Petitioner with three Woe and place them at any Temple not yet chosen.
4. Create two Pariah Petitioners with four Woe each and place them each at a different Temple.
5. Then choose a Temple at random and make them Blasphemous.

Part IV: Watcher to the Flames

While you play the Hierophant, there is also a second role which you must fulfill, in your part as **Flame-Watcher** to the **Celestial Audience**. Through the Celestial Audience, you will care for the

Companions, friends, and common folk of Isha, and ensure they hold Wizards to account when they fail them.

Within this Part of *The Book of Flames*, you will learn your responsibilities as a member of the Celestial Audience and the unique rules governing your own domain, that of the people of Isha, and the flames that guide them.

Principles of the Flame-Watcher

All wizards are lonely, indeed: all wizards know this. In your part as the Celestial Audience, you are the guardian of this truth, who provides its implications as they play out across the world of Isha. This truth informs your **Principles**, which guide your hand and inform your decisions. As Flame-Watcher, your Principles are:

Maintain the essential personhood of every person in Isha. They are governed by material desires and class pressure, in ways that frequently contradict. They want power, safety, stability — some of which they may seek from the Pact, but some of which they may desire on their own. Everyone, even the cruelest monster, celebrates birthdays, attends festivals, mourns the dead, and acts as part of a social system that exists beyond them. No one exists at the whim of a wizard. Give them the grace and dignity of any human — let the good make mistakes, the bad offer redemption, and for their lives to take unexpected twists and turns.

Apply pressure to the few relationships wizards have. Companions are those few who do care for a Wizard, but not only are they an exception to a broader rule, they have their own complicated feelings about their relationship. Companions have needs, care they wish was reciprocated, love they wish was returned. Companions are people of Isha, who are acted upon by Isha's social reality, and who succumb to the pressures of society in ways Wizards cannot fully grasp.

Explore the centrality of faith beyond the Pact. Spirituality and religion are critical to the people of Isha. The festivals and calls to prayer form the rhythm of time, the prophets provide moral guidance and philosophy, the flames grant excuses to see your friends and sit with them in peace. Wizards, segregated as they are from the spiritual practices of Isha, will always underestimate the impact of faith on the daily lives of the populace and on their Companions. While they may try, wizards cannot anticipate how their actions will impact the people of Isha, or how easy it is for them to become reviled.

Interventions of the Flame-Watcher

When acting as a member of the Celestial Audience, you will have opportunities to advance your Principles and assert your perspective on the world. You may accomplish this through **Interventions**, questions, statements, and Impact which can intrude into any scene at any moment. These include:

- Introduce a new character with a challenging perspective.
- Present someone with the social toll of their behavior.
- Describe how the actions of the Pact disrupt the daily lives of ordinary folk.
- Tell someone how their Companion wishes to help them, and what it will cost to gain that help. Refer to *Rules for Companions* on page XXXX.
- Determine how the populace at large reacts to events unfolding, and how this shapes the stability of their faith. *Add a new Supplicant to any Temple.*

Rules for Companions

What beautiful and patient souls, those who choose to spend their lives with wizards. It is hard to love a man who can never make time for you, a distant and sometimes cold love, an unfamiliar sensation in one's heart. Wizards are frequently blind to the depth and scope of the support Companions provide them. Indeed, if a wizard had no Companions, he would have no time to actually perform magic, for he would be forced to spend his precious weeks caring for himself instead of practicing sorcery.

Playing As Companions

In your part as the Celestial Audience, you play as Companions in any scene that features them. You may also, as you see fit, insist that a Companion belongs in a scene. If you're not comfortable playing a specific Companion for any reason, or you're in the scene as well, ask another Wizard to play as that Companion instead. [footnote: It's common, over the course of many months, for the same Companion to be played by multiple different members of the Celestial Audience.]

Companions provide a certain care for their wizard. The higher the wizard's Element is, the greater the amount of care provided by that Companion is valued, and the more vital the

Companion is for the Wizard's sense of self. Each Companion provides that care in their own way.

Each Companion possesses their own Need. While this Need isn't apparent from their initial creation, the more you play that Companion, the more you should strive to identify that Need and articulate it. Some possible Needs may include:

- Support, comfort, and camaraderie
- Intimacy, love, and tenderness
- Material wealth and glory
- Magical secrets and power

Companions & Favor

If a wizard asks for a favor from one of his Companions, they'll do their best to help, as long as the favor is returned. This favor can be used to:

- Acting as the wizard's surrogate, attending the Wizardmoot, the King's birthday party, or another event in his stead and fulfilling that social obligation.
- Deliver a message on behalf of the wizard to any character.
- Improve the Lore of his Isle and/or Sanctum.
- Cast a Spell (assuming they have the ability to, per page XXXX).
- Produce a minor Gift for the wizard's own Domain.
- Give another wizard a minor Complication.

However, Companions require support and compassion in turn. Whenever they perform a favor for their Wizard in this fashion, that Companion must ask for a favor in return, one which aligns with their Need. These may include asking the wizard to:

- Spend Time with his Companion next month.
- Spend Time on his Isle or Sanctum, to improve it.
- Give the Companion a magical Treasure as a present.
- Take the Companion somewhere outside Isha, on vacation.
- Teach the Companion a spell of their choice.
- Return someone else the Companion loves back to life.
- Violate Pact-Law in some fashion. [footnote: The favor requested may be impossible for the Wizard to accomplish, or accomplishing it may threaten to destroy the world. This

may be a concern to the Companion, but it will not stop their desire. They long for this favor even if it cannot be done, and the impossibility of the task is part of the friction present.]

Once a Companion has made this request to the Wizard, they've made their desires known. They will not provide Care to the Wizard until the Wizard grants them this kindness.

Danger & Temptation

To serve as a Companion of a Wizard puts one in constant danger, and it is frequently a thankless job. The suffering or disloyalty of Companions is a frequent Complication, and may be caused by social unrest, dark magic, or the machinations of powers far beyond the Pact's control. Injured or Disloyal Companions will not provide their Care for their wizard.

Injured Companions will heal after 3 months, or through the magic of a wizard. Disloyal Companions may choose to return after 3 months (their flight of fancy settling down), or may return if their Need is provided for. [footnote: No known magic may force a Companion to provide Care if they don't wish to. Even if controlled, the Companion will find some mechanism of rebellion.]

If another wizard or powerful being may identify and offer a Companion their Need, they may tempt that Companion towards Disloyalty.

Companions in Domains [box]

Sometimes a Companion will find themselves serving a second role in another Domain as well. One can imagine circumstances in which a Sorcerer's prentice finds himself representing the Sorcerer in the Court of the King, or the Mariner's wife unwittingly acting as a Pawn of the Devil. In these circumstances, the Companion is represented by multiple game-pieces. Should some unfortunate twist of fate befall them in that other Domain, they may also be rendered unfit to act as Companion.

New Companions

It takes an extraordinary amount of time and effort for a wizard to develop trust with another person, and to welcome them into his life as a new Companion. To begin, the wizard chooses

which Elemental Circle he wishes for his new potential Companion to care for. The potential Companion must be a named character who already exists before the Celestial Audience. [footnote: While the "poaching" of another wizard's Companion in this fashion is not against Pact-Law per se, retaliation against the offending wizard would most likely be viewed sympathetically by the remainder of the Pact.] The wizard must then have a scene with the potential Companion, in which he courts them and attempts to form an emotional connection with them. At the conclusion of the scene, it is the Companion's honest choice as to whether they wish to provide Care for the Wizard in the way he seeks.

If they accept, the wizard must spend an amount of Time with that Companion equal to his associated Elements, working together to forge a profound bond of trust. This Time can be spread out across multiple Months. Once this Time has been spent, the new Companion will be one of *his* Companions first and foremost, regardless of the occupation or loyalty they held previously.

Magical Companions

Prentices

A wizard's prentice is their student and eventual successor, someone training to fill their role within the Pact. Wizards are notoriously poor teachers, and yet somehow prentices are able to make it in the world regardless.

A prentice can reasonably be expected to be able to cast any spell within the Grimoire, if given enough time and support. They can cast at Personal Import (D6) whenever they please. They can cast at Arcane Import (D8) if they're given an afternoon to study the spell in question and practice. They can cast at Mighty Import (D10) if their Wizard is present with them, providing advice and support. They cannot cast at Mythic Import (D12).

Prentices are treated as having the same Elements as their master, subtracting 1. If a prentice has a negative Element, they cannot cast spells in that Element at all.

Prentices have access to the same Humble Magic as their master and their own Familiar, but have no Pact-Fragment and no Treasures.

A Wizard's Family

While a wizard isn't supposed to allow his family and personal friends to access magic, it's an open secret that the wife of a wizard will often know a spell or two. Which spell they might know depends on what they would have been able to steal from their wizard, or that he taught them aimlessly and without meaning to, and such vulnerability is determined by their associated Element:

- **Earth:** A spell to help with accomplishing mundane chores, such as *Animating The Inanimate* or *Hand of Power*.
- **Water:** A spell of transfiguration or duplicity, such as *Mimesis* or *Conjure Illusions*.
- **Air:** A spell of defense and aggression, such as *Bombardment* or *Hex*.
- **Fire:** A spell demonstrating some fascinating property of magic, such as *Mastery of the Major Winds* or *Soothsaying*.

Even if they don't know such magic, it's still likely they would possess a Treasure of some kind — perhaps a Wand, Amulet, or Vestment. They wouldn't have any Wards against magic.

Strange Companions

Every wizard has an option for a Companion which itself is both magical and strange in its nature. The rules for how the magic of this being functions can be found in a different Wizard's Codex. Should you need them:

- The Necromancer's **Demon** is a Bound Demon, as described in the *Book of Chains* on page XX.
- The Hierophant's **Angel** is a Denizen of the Furthest Realms, as described in the *Book of Stars* on page XX.
- The Warlock's **Ancestor** is a dead spirit (which, if it turned against the Warlock, would become a Foe of Death) as described in the *Book of Gates* on page XX.
- The Mariner's **Selkie** is a Nereid as described in the *Book of Storms* on page XX.
- The Faustian's **Witch** is a Witch as described in the *Book of Tomes* on page XX.
- The Sage's **Star** is a fallen star, and no one knows precisely how the magic of such a creature functions, for it has been quite some time since a star fell upon Isha.
- The Sorcerer's **Homunculus** is a Homunculus as described in the *Grimoire* on page XX.

The wizard is not necessarily aware of the precise magical properties of their Companion, and as a Companion that magical being would not use its powers while it remains loyal to their Wizard.

The Laws of the Land

While the laws of the King are established by the King and enforced by his men, the laws of the people of Isha are much older, and far more rooted in their ways. A king may flout these laws for as long as he wields power over the archipelago, but when he falls it will be the ancient laws which catch him and inflict their punishment. In times of plenty, the people are lax with their laws, but in times of tremendous need, the Laws of the Land rear their ugly heads once more, and Isha trembles with their gavel.

The Laws of the Land

There are a few traditions and principles which, in a common-sense fashion, sit at the core of the Laws of the Land. Preachers and rabblers will return to these principles again and again.

1. The unfamiliar, the unnatural, and the unrelatable are all evil.
2. We must return to how things were when we were children.
3. We must stand up for our families, our land, and our faith.

From these principles, all other laws may be deduced:

- Magic is considered unnatural and unrelatable, and therefore older and more powerful wizards naturally run afoul of the First Principle.
- Queerness, homosexuality, and gender exploration are all unfamiliar, unnatural, and an affront to the families of Isha, leaving them at the mercy of the Laws of the Land.
- Murder, theft, and violence are only against the Laws of the Land if they're committed against one's family or in a way that is unfamiliar or unnatural.
- Working against the orthodoxy of the Immortal Flame, or violating the Laws of the Temple, is an undeniable rejection of how things were when we were young, and warrants an immediate response.
- Omens, symbols, prophecies, and other signs of the gods' influence upon the mortal world must be heeded.

Everyone in Isha, on some level, acknowledges these laws. Even Cults that stand against these principles, or anchorites who delight in flouting the traditional way of things, still *know* the laws hold true.

Who Determines The Law

The Laws of the Land are composed of a combination of oral traditions, religious teachings, and "common sense" arguments. They are frequently ill-defined and interpreted by gut instinct. They are dictated by figures of social authority within communities — patriarchs, priests, prophets, and respected statesmen. Any two individuals within Isha will disagree on the precise application of the Laws of the Land, or how best to utilize them.

Mob Justice

When the Laws of the Land are considered to be wantonly in violation, special Complications may be distributed by the populace alongside the regular list of Impacts.

Minor Complications:

- Mark the violating wizard with Conviction. As long as they possess this Conviction, ordinary people treat them poorly, spit on them, and do everything they can to ignore them. A wizard may spend Time at a Temple to remove the Conviction.
- Mark the wizard's Sanctum with Conviction. As long as it possesses this Conviction, people (potentially including the wizard's Companions) will avoid the Sanctum. Change its Lore to reflect the graffiti and malice directed its way.

Major Complications:

- Create a new Cult in another wizard's Domain, with at least 3 Conviction. Their Dogma includes: "Magic is an abomination and it must be opposed at all costs."
- One of the wizard's Companions is violently attacked for their association with the Wizard. They cannot provide Care until the Wizard suitably demonstrates his fealty to the Laws of the Land.

Part V: Denizens of the Temples

Your reign across Isha is absolute, all those who pray to the Flame know to fear and respect your presence. And yet there are those who even now challenge your authority, those who work within and outside the Temples to orchestrate your downfall. While at times they may be helpful, you must stand eternally vigilant, for at any moment they may prove your undoing.

Within this Part of *The Book of Flames*, you will learn the rules for Mundane People, the powers and personalities of Prophets, and the extent of the threat produced by a Cult.

Mundane People

Mortals, common folk, ignoramuses, serfs, civilians — wizards have used dozens of words for them over the years. They've always been around, though: the countless unremarkable peasants whose lives are grist for the endless mill of creation. They believe themselves to matter. They believe their actions to be worth something. They are unaware of how fragile they are. Insects on the edge of oblivion.

Individuals

Often, mundane people are entirely irrelevant on their own, only wielding any sort of power when in groups. As Flame-Keeper, the lives of individual humans will often emerge as part of your Domain.

Mundane humans lack access to magic and have no Wards. Sometimes a mundane human will have a simple weapon or blunt object. Through training, mundane humans may be able to hold their own against a wizard, as long as that wizard doesn't resort to magic. Humans are remarkably fragile — a swift blow to their head from something as simple as a wizard's humble magic can be enough to kill them. Killing a mundane human is a violation of the Laws of the Land (see page XXXX).

When roleplaying individual humans in scenes, focus on their goals for that scene and the people they love outside of the scene.

Lifepath Generator

If you need to determine the trajectory of a mundane person's life, roll a number of D8s equal to the number of decades they've been alive (rounding up), and arrange them to see how their life occurred, with each dice result representing the tenor of a decade of their life. Ignore any results which contradict anything established about the character.

Glyph	Years 0-19	Years 20-39	Years 40-59	Years 60+
☹	Death of a parent, loss of a home, freak tragic accident.	Death of a lover, exiled from home, haunted by guilt.	Death of a child, hopes dashed, legacy spoiled.	Haunted by death, wandering aimlessly, forgotten and alone.
👤	Regular peasant life, learned a trade, hard honest work.	Solid work, built a life, marriage proposal.	Build a strong home, many children, calm and unremarkable days.	Cared for by family, keep the fire warm, rocking chair at heart.
♂	Fought to survive, learned violence too young, nasty scar.	Feared warrior, foes slain, battlefield dominated.	War came to the door, home burned, grief spread.	Stern and cold, guardian against the dark, prefers the night.
♀	Privileged youth, loving parents, everything provided for.	A lover and a layabout, heartbreaker, homewrecker.	Matured artist, acclaimed for their work, respected by peers.	Master of a craft, feared and ruthless teacher, auspicious legacy.
🚢	Traveled from distant lands, found a new home, sailed aboard a ship.	Explore new lands, venture far from home, go on adventures.	Reinvent self somewhere new, earn a fortune in trade, captain a sturdy ship.	Dream of distant lands, send others on quests, seek out forgotten treasure.
🔮	Encountered magic, miraculous change, still carry the mark.	Student of old knowledge, ambitious researcher, curious youth.	Bitter intellectual, disillusioned by the world, desperate for enlightenment.	Wise old soul, educator to children, a bit wickerwise.

Groups of Mundane People

Groups of mundane humans operate together as one organism. Through training and discipline, a group of humans can even potentially pose a threat to a wizard. When roleplaying as a group in a scene, create spokespeople to represent the will of the group who can have more

individuality and personality. Focus on the goals of the group and consider how the group disagrees and what could cause the group to fracture.

Prophets

Prophets are visionaries of a past that has been lost and a future which may yet still occur. They are powerful tools in the hands of the Pact, but dangerous and unreliable forces when turned against the Pyretic Orthodoxy. A Prophet is a beautiful and fragile thing, their lives considered sacred by the populace, but their arrival heralds headaches and countless frustrations for the Pact. They must be neutralized as efficiently as possible, through distraction and the satisfaction of operating within the system.

Creating a Prophet

To create a Prophet, determine which Populace they emerge from and look to the current position of **Jupiter** (♃) to determine how they discovered their capacity for prophecy, and the strange quirk which their prophetic nature drives them towards. If Jupiter lies within two Houses, use both Houses to determine the discovery and quirk [footnote: You may also choose your preferred options from the lists.]

Jupiter's (♃)'s House	Discovery	Quirk
Aries	Caught a lucky glimpse of the Immortal Flame and had a sudden burning vision	Wraps themselves head-to-toe in rags
Taurus	Experienced a miraculous cure in the presence of the Immortal Flame	Sleeps under a bridge
Gemini	Had a mental breakdown, fled their life, and stumbled into epiphany	Refuses to acknowledge wizards
Cancer	Lost the love of their life and dedicated their mind and soul to Ithax	Wanders the streets mumbling to themselves
Leo	Spent hours and days sitting by the Immortal Flame until wisdom struck	Spends all their time on top of a stone pillar
Virgo	Managed to sneak onto Sacred Tahv, where they	Refuses to leave a small hut in the woods

Jupiter's (♃)'s House	Discovery	Quirk
	beheld the lava of Mt. Ithax	
Libra	Visited by visions of Ithax in their sleep	Grows their hair wildly and unkemptly
Scorpio	Snuck into the Temple over and over to catch a glimpse of the Flame	Writes compulsively onto their skin
Sagittarius	Traveled to the edge of the earth and encountered ancient and forgotten secrets	Speaks entirely in tongues
Capricorn	Intentionally induced visions through sleep deprivation and torture	Will only eat moss grown on the walls of the Temple
Aquarius	Born under an auspicious omen that seared a vision into their mind	Surrounded by rabbits
Pisces	Driven mad and blind by the Immortal Flame	Despises any light not from the Immortal Flame

Prophets and Magic [box]

Prophets are not capable of working magic beyond their limited access to divination. On rare occasions, the Immortal Flame will bless the Prophet with access to true magical power. When this occurs, refer to *The Book of Runes, Part V: Denizens of Magic — Occultists* on page XXXX and work with the Rune-Watcher to determine their access to magic and how their presence interferes with both Domains.

Prophets In Play

Prophets are present either at Temples or in Cults. Because of this, they're never alone — a Prophet is always integrated into the community around them. Prophets lack access to magic or weaponry, but are capable of asserting and defending themselves through social authority.

Prophets may, once per scene, receive a vision. When the Prophet receives a vision, they may choose to do one of the following:

- Issue one Cult Dogma or declare a Law which the people of Isha know is wise and true. Any who break it will be subject to *The Law of the Land* on page XXXX.
- Ask the Celestial Audience one question about the past, which the Celestial Audience answers with cryptic and mysterious language. The Prophet knows this answer.
- If the Sage is Present, choose any Luminary (see *The Book of Stars*) and ask the Sage one question about their Destiny. The Sage answers in cryptic and mysterious language. The Prophet knows this answer.

Prophets may also cast spells of Divination when they have access to the Immortal Flame (or, if they are part of a Cult, if they have access to the sacred objects of that Cult). When they do so, they do not obtain Glyphs through rolling dice, but may instead procure Glyphs by sacrificing specific objects, memories, or forces to the Immortal Flame:

- ☞ The Prophet sacrifices any material object with a physical value equal to at least one month of a servant's pay.
- ♂ The Prophet spills their own blood, sweat, tears, or viscera.
- ♀ The Prophet deprives themselves of food and water to the point of near-starvation.
- ♀ The Prophet spends multiple hours in a state of constant movement and prayer.
- ☾ The Prophet destroys a magical object with no possibility of repair.
- ℥ The Prophet kills someone who they love tremendously.
- ☿ The Prophet sheds all memories and emotional connection to the most important person in their life.
- ☼ The Prophet kills themselves.
- ♠ The Prophet makes a deal with the Devil.

Cults and Other Religions

A Cult is a malignant tumor infesting the beating heart of Isha, some heterodoxical fancy that has seized hold of the imaginations of the archipelago. Cults are a perversion of the Temple's

structure, an alternate center of faith and support that interacts unpredictably and dangerously with the Domain it colonizes.

Creating a Cult

A new Cult in rejection of the Pyretic Orthodoxy, either from the heretical escalation of Temple fanaticism, the collapse of their previous belief systems, or the sudden intrusion of new philosophical ideas into Isha. Cults are created in any other wizard's Domain. A Cult is governed by a Blasphemous Doctrine. Pick one or randomly choose one that reflects the Cult's ideology, or create your own. [footnote: To create your own Blasphemy, write a statement which you think is the core of the Cult's promise to others, then choose which Classes it appeals to.]

Then, create and name the Cult's leader. If the Cult has any Supplicants, the highest-Class Supplicant is the Leader. The Leader is an ordinary human (see page XXXX). If the Leader should ever die, create a Complication for the Cult's associated Wizard and create and name a new Leader.

Finally, consult the Lists of Dogma to determine the ideology of this new Cult from page XXXX. [footnote: Or invent your own.] Cults have 1 Dogma for each Conviction they possess. It can be assumed the Cult otherwise carries the same beliefs as the Pyretic Orthodoxy. The Dogma matches up with the Classes the Cult appeals to:

- The Gentry enjoy **Vain** and **Perverse** Dogma.
- The Merchants enjoy **Vain** and **Delirious** Dogma.
- The Artisans enjoy **Delirious** and **Apocalyptic** Dogma.
- The Peasants enjoy **Apocalyptic** and **Ascetic** Dogma.
- The Pariahs enjoy **Ascetic** and **Perverse** Dogma.

Cults in Play

Treat Cults similarly to Temples for the purposes of gaining Supplicants from Watching The Stars. Cults are always considered to be celebrating a Holiday.

During the Visions Phase, Cults seek to recruit new Populaces and integrate themselves into their Domain. Proceed down this list, performing the first task whose criteria are met.

- ***If the Cult has any Supplicants***, remove 1 Woe from each Supplicant. The Cult then gains each Supplicant's Benefaction.
- ***If the Cult has less than 5 Conviction***, create a Complication for the Cult's associated wizard (as the Cult grounds itself in the wizard's Domain), then gain +5 Conviction.
- ***If the Cult has less Abundance than Conviction***, create a Complication for the Cult's associated wizard (as the Cult ravages his Domain for power), then gain Abundance equal to Conviction.
- ***Otherwise***, the Cult asserts its legitimacy onto Isha. Create a Complication for each other wizard, then move each Supplicant with at least 3 Woe onto the Cult.

A Cult in a scene, on its own, is no more powerful than any other group of mortals.

Dismantling a Cult

A Cult cannot be easily struck down — even if its leader is slain, the false ideology lives on in the hearts of its adherents. A Cult must be systematically dismantled and reintegrated into the Pyretic Orthodoxy.

You may schedule Time on a Cult in order to influence public opinion on the ideology. Spend this time, along with a combination of Abundance and Conviction from any combination of Temples equal to the Cult's combined Abundance and Conviction. [footnote: For example, if the Cult has 3 Abundance and 2 Conviction, you may spend 5 Abundance and 0 Conviction, or 1 Abundance and 4 Conviction, or any other combination.]

- If more Abundance was spent than Conviction, describe to the Celestial Audience the way you undermine the Cult's ideology and cut off their access to resources. Change the Lore of the associated Wizard's Domain appropriately.
- If more Conviction was spent than Abundance, describe to the Celestial Audience the changes you make to the Pyretic Orthodoxy to make room for the Cult's ideology. Change the Lore of your own Domain appropriately.

Lists of Cult Dogma

Apocalyptic Dogma

1. Ithax will someday return and bring the worthy to a paradise at the edge of the world.

2. Wizards are conspiring to bring about the end of days and destroy the world once more.
3. Soon kings will be forced to till fields and farmers will drink wine atop golden thrones, and the natural order will be upended.
4. A star is hurtling towards the archipelago and will annihilate Isha soon.
5. We have angered the Leviathan in our hubris and he will destroy the islands in retribution if we do not appease him.
6. The gates of death will soon open and the dead will walk amongst the living.
7. The true prophet will soon emerge, if they have not yet already, and will destroy the Orthodoxy that falsely rules Isha.
8. We must sacrifice the lives of others in order to prevent the oncoming apocalypse.

Ascetic Dogma

1. The public flaunting of wealth and fashion is an affront to the Immortal Flame; those with wealth must give it away.
2. Adherents should wear itchy and uncomfortable clothing to demonstrate their humility.
3. The Temples themselves are an affront to the prophets and deny true presence with the Flame.
4. The natural world contains all the answers needed; civilization is a farce.
5. Vows of silence and chastity demonstrate prudence and respect.
6. The teachings of the Prophets are a complete fabrication invented to keep you in line.
7. Those who violate social norms must be humiliated and tortured.
8. We must return to a time when men were strong and laws were just.

Delirious Dogma

1. Ithax has reincarnated himself in the form of a young rabbit who we must protect at all costs.
2. It is a sign of devotion to publicly self-flagellate oneself.
3. The Immortal Flames must be extinguished in order to return Ithax to life.
4. The true god of this world is not Ithax but instead Ymos the world-serpent.
5. The universe is a dream and someday its dreamers will awaken.
6. Death is good, and to die is to be blessed with a kiss from the gods, and the dead will guide us to wisdom.

7. The human soul contains a dragon's egg, and if one could cut open the body they could free the egg trapped within.
8. Starvation and sleep deprivation bring you closer to understanding spiritual truth.

Perverse Dogma

1. Ithax and Ephris were lovers, and homosexual love is a sign of shared devotion.
2. One can experience the Immortal Flame through large quantities of drugs and alcohol.
3. Sex and procreation is a public demonstration of one's devotion to the gods.
4. Adherents prove their loyalty through ritual dismemberment.
5. Massive drunken revelries and bacchenalias are spiritually necessary.
6. The creation of massive elegant works of art provide windows into the true soul of the gods.
7. Physical pleasure and stimulation matter more than morality.
8. Ithax is secretly a woman who gave birth to the universe.

Vain Dogma

1. You don't need to be a prophet to interpret the Immortal Flames, anyone can do it.
2. Ithax is a metaphor for self-actualization and spiritual wholeness.
3. Selfishness is a virtue: you are the only person who is real.
4. Ithax chose your soul to be more important than other people's lives.
5. It is ethically good to accumulate as much financial wealth as possible.
6. Men should marry multiple times, and their wives should act like property.
7. Flaunt your faith through expensive clothing and decadent jewelry.
8. There is no difference between truth and lies.

Part VI: Secrets of the Flame

The Immortal Flame burns with the secrets of the future and the past. It is a single droplet of the god-font of creation, a single ounce of the glory that seeded the world with life and purpose. If Ithax was real, and the world a creation of his love for his brother, where have they gone?

Within this Part of *The Book of Flames* you will learn the secrets of the Temples of Isha and the teachings of the Pyretic Orthodoxy.

Temples of Isha

Temple Hestar

Whenever you spend Time with the monks of Temple Hestar, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Temple Hestar is built at the foot of Mt. Ithax upon sacred Tahv, a mountainous and small island marked by black shores. It is made from ancient yellow brick and the only path is a narrow, easily flooded, stone bridge. It is named after a lover of Ithax, who tended to his hearth.
- Hestar is the temple where the priests and abbots of other temples are trained. Those monks who stay in Hestar reject the company of all others, spending their days in constant meditation and self-reflection upon the mysteries of the flame.
- The ancient temple is built from ochre-colored volcanic rock, which reek of brimstone and sulphur. While there were once many other temples across Tahv, Hestar is the only one remaining — the others were destroyed when Mt. Ithax erupted.

Temple Krolis

Whenever you spend Time with the pilgrims of Temple Krolis, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Temple Krolis is the largest of the temples, built into the heart of Ishana and a glorious centerpiece of the city. It is made from gray stone and bears an enormous tarnished-gold dome. It is named after the priest who financed its rebuilding following its collapse during the Tragedies.
- The priests of Krolis care little for tradition or orthodoxy, and instead focus on entertaining the vast crowds who flock to the temple each month, sometimes reduced to glorified tour guides.
- The Temple Krolis is so crowded that people have been known to occasionally get trampled underfoot, and many of the shrines around the immortal flame have been worn away by generations of contact.

Temple Notor

Whenever you spend Time with the masses of Temple Notor, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Temple Notor is a run-down temple built along the waterside of Scuttleport, a complicated added-to structure that serves as a beacon within the undercity. Its walls are made from yellowed brick and are covered with graffiti. It is named after the Prophet Notor, who guarded the flame during the Tragedies.
- The monks of Notor are dedicated to charity, preparing vast amounts of food for Scuttleport's starving populace. Many monks take on a hunger vow themselves, acting as mendicants in the streets of Ishana.
- Notor never has enough beds for everyone who needs it, can never provide everyone with what they ask for, and can never be more than a band-aid for the misery of the downtrodden underbelly of Ishana.

Temple Zephon

Whenever you spend Time with the solitude of Temple Zephon, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Temple Zephon is the most remote of the temples, its huge stone dome has overgrown with grass and trees, and its flame exposed to the winds that buffet the Chalk Cliffs. It is named after the western wind, and some say it was once a temple to a different god.
- There are very few priests of Zephon, and they tend to be eccentrics, stylites, glossolaliacs, and hermits. They're woefully under-equipped to take care of the venerable and decrepit temple.
- The forest growing into Zephon is itself full of old magic, and the villagers of the nearby settlement of Edoch give both it and the temple a wide berth.

Temple Ushin

Whenever you spend Time with the celebrants of Temple Ushin, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Temple Ushin is historically the wealthiest Temple (and the newest), financed by King Alexios the Brave in honor of his mother. It overlooks the shipyards of Caravesse, and is the Temple favored by nobility across the Archipelago.
- While Hestar is the spiritual center of the Orthodoxy, Ushin is its administrative center, with the Pontifex's enormous estate and treasury located on its grounds. The priests of Ushin are wealthy and soft, frequently descended from noble families.
- Ushin is a hotbed for heretics and apostates, those who work against the orthodoxy and dream of sedition from Tahv. The vast amounts of wealth that flow through its walls are rumored to earn the nobles who bankroll it both spiritual and physical indulgences.

The Legends of the Immortal Flame

As recorded by the Gyrovague Edon in the years following the Apocalypse, and translated from Hieratic to Demotic Ishanian by the monks of Temple Hestar upon Sacred Tahv during the Age of Silks, under the reign of the Steward-King Obnis Kai.

The Creation of the World

Spend Time during a month to adjust, re-translate, or change a single word of how the tale is understood in the monastery.

In the beginning of the world, the sea was black and full of terrors. All beasts which could be swam within the Primordial Sea, writhing and gnawing on scraps of life. There was no beast greater and more monstrous than *Ymos*, whose coils wrapped around the infinite ocean ten thousand times. *Ymos* held many treasures (indeed, all treasures which could one day exist lay within his primordial hoard) but none were more treasured than the Egg which contained his death. He was so fearful of this egg that he wrapped himself around it, keeping it safe from any creature which sought to use it against him. In his fear the warmth of his coils incubated the egg, and it was from his death the world would birth.

Three gods emerged from the egg: wise *Ephris*, beautiful *Oraia*, and harsh *Kruthos*. While it was *Kruthos*'s blade which took *Ymos*'s life, it was *Oraia*'s cruel hands which carved forth his eyes and pulled the stars from his hoard, scattering them into the sky and ripping through the clouds covering the endless sea, creating the sun and moon. Finally, it was *Ephris* who fashioned each

of dreadful Ymos's scales into a soul and granted such a soul to all the monstrosities of the sea, transforming them into all the beasts and men who wander the earth to this day.

The gods did not act without a witness, however. Ymos's heartbroken mother, *Mulgra*, wept at what had become of her son's desiccated corpse. She grabbed his blood and her tears and fashioned from the viscera the death of each being created by the gods. She fed these deaths to the monstrosities of the Primordial Sea, granting them the knowledge from such a concoction on how to kill their newfound enemies. Many more of these deaths she transformed into beautiful women, golden treasures, and iron blades, such that men would covet them unaware of their true nature. Some of these creatures would be called vampires, others would be called demons, while one would be known as *Leviathan*.

Each of the three gods set forth to create their own portion of the cosmos, divided in thirds with the bones of Ymos. Oraia governed the stars and the fates of the universe, fashioning a vast celestial audience and chariots to carry the Sun and the Moon. Her children; the wandering planets and the zodiac houses, became the gods of the Celestial Pantheon. In this way, these gods govern the destiny of the future, the secrets of time and the transfiguration of man into beast upon the canvas of the world, spiriting away those most blessed by the stars to live in a paradise of their own creation within the constellations, never facing their death.

Kruthos built beneath the soil of the deepest sea, carving eleven gates of death and appointing eleven gods to watch over his creation. Through these gates he could undo Mulgra's treachery, for each individual could through his grace journey through the Gates of Death, washing away the troubles and toils of their life and become wholly clean in preparation for the final paradise at the far end of creation. Those of simple lives would spend little within his gates, while those who faced great strife and conflict might have to spend countless centuries in the purification of death before venturing into the hands of Kruthos and his Chthonic Pantheon.

Ephris was a quiet god, who delighted in the creation of countless fish, capricorns, and nereids. His children were the winds and tides, seafoam and storming waves, and all the magic between the stars and the deep. He created all the creatures of the world, from the smallest fish to the greatest wolf, and mankind as well, who were his favorite. He was too trusting, and was thus taken unaware when his blood-brother *Ithax* stole magic from his lips and taught it to mankind, allowing them to pull the coils of ancient Ymos from the sea and create the first islands. The emergence of land was such a blight upon Ephris's perfect sea that he retired to the edge of the world, mourning his desecrated creation. It was through Ithax's wisdom that magic could be

practiced by the children of man, and the origin of such magic burns in the immortal flame, which we revere today upon Isha.

The Two Gods; and the Creation of Flame

Spend Time during a month to adjust, re-translate, or change a single word of how the tale is understood in the monastery.

Once upon a time, noble Ephris chose to survey his creation, and so he loaded up his boat with ten thousand cattle and ten thousand servants and set sail across the seas. It was in this manner of travel that he found himself in the southernmost reaches of the world, right against the edge of the sea, where it is so cold that one could set foot upon floating islands of ice and tread between them (indeed, much in the same fashion as the people living there still do today). It was on one of these icebergs that Ephris discovered the young Ithax, wild and untamed by the world. When Ithax saw great Ephris, he declared; "If it's not the king of nowhere!"

Ephris, struck by a harshness unbeknownst to him, fell upon Ithax and the two fought for seven days and seven nights, lashing at each other with incredible blows of such fury that the reverberations of their violence is still called "thunder" today. It was only at the conclusion of the seventh day, when the two warriors had no choice but to admit their parity, that they set aside arms and sat down together atop the iceberg to share in their food. It was then that Ithax told of his story: for he was the smallest of the storm giants, the son of the mighty giant-god Great Ourophagos, and Ithax was banished from those lands for questioning the will of his master. Sharp Ithax distrusted all kings by his nature, and when he met the god of the seas, he had assumed caring Ephris was a tyrant as cruel as his father. But in their conflict Ithax learned the true nature of Ephris, and saw him to contain also the gentleness of the inlet tide, and so in their fighting the two came to know one another.

From that day on the two gods were inseparable, and delighted in the creation of countless new beings together. While Ephris carried the Scales of Ymos, through which he could grant new souls to all beings and in doing so fashion them form, Ithax was the carrier of creativity and imagination, and so was full of ideas on what to create. Ephris would have been content sculpting crabs and minnows until the Leviathan ate the sun, but Ithax dreamed of new creatures still. He made birds and seals, beetles and lions. He even wrestled the monstrosities of Mulgra and forced souls into their gullets, transforming them into orcas, wolves, rats, and flies.

His favorite of all his creations, made in the image of himself and his brother-God Ephris, was mankind.

Ephris had little regard for many of Ithax's creations, for his own children danced beneath the sea. They were the nereids, the nixies and pixies, the kelpies and selkies, the water-fairies and strangest folk, who were the first of his creations, and so knew of the soul in their stomach and could pull it out at will; and in so doing, shed their form and become something new. Ephris spent more and more of his time with his children, running and dancing with them, while Ithax continued his great work of creation.

One day, while Ephris was away at an umbral bacchanalia, mankind came to Ithax to ask for help. "We are cold on our rafts and in our ships, without dry land to settle down upon," declared man, "and we are hunted by nereids and orcas, wolves and flies. Our deaths are everywhere around us and our lives are short."

Ithax took pity on man, promising to create something to help him, but when he reached into the basket of scales there was nothing left. Ithax paled, for he knew then that all of creation was in its final place, and if he wished to give mankind his gift he would have to take from another god. But he had no choice (a promise is a promise), and so he climbed up into the sky and through seduction, convinced one of the stars to part with her destiny. He rode her dying body back down to the sea, the first falling star, and with his arrival he let loose the fire of creation, granting mankind the power to shape their destinies and weave magic. With this flame they reached beneath the sea and pulled forth countless islands to rule as their own.

When Ephris returned from his bacchanal, he was horrified to see before him, not the open sea of his creation, but a world covered in great masses of land. Upon this land mankind slaughtered animal and fished in abundance, they built great fires and gave countless sacrifices to Ithax, the god who brought them such fire. They held no gratitude in their hearts for wise Ephris, and so he turned his back on mankind. It is said that this is why man, unique among all creatures in the world, cannot universally understand his peers, and why the wizards of man both seek such great power and bring such horrendous tragedy. And yet we are the favored people of Ithax, whose greatest gift burns still in Isha, which has at various points been called the Land of the Fallen Star, and before its fragmentation during the Tragedies was called the Empire of Stars, for it is where the immortal flame burns still.

The Prophet Notor; the End of the World

Spend Time during a month to adjust, re-translate, or change a single word of how the tale is understood in the monastery.

Once upon a time the world was ending, and no one present knew it was true. It was a time of arrogance and cruelty, of starving men engorged on the dreams and hopes of others, of sickness and heartache ignored and dismissed. The currency of this age was the soul of a man. The magi and kings of this world did not know their days were numbered; or if they did, they could not be bothered to care. The common folk suspected the world was ending but they could not speak its name. The tyranny of the present was a great wheel rolling forever forwards, crushing any will to escape. To speak apocalyptica so openly invited it to your doorstep. And so the world was ending, and no one present knew.

The Prophet Notor braved the heights of Mount Ithax, and in the flame of Temple Sepoch saw the true name of the apocalypse. The Prophet knew then that the world would end, and knew in turn how it would burn. The Prophet Notor tried to warn the priests of the Temples, but they were wealthy from the gifts lavished to them by their lords, and they turned their heads away. The Prophet Notor tried to warn the kings beneath the stars, but they listened to the whispers of their masters, and they turned their heads away. The Prophet Notor tried to warn the magi of the Ergoad, the masters of sail and flame, but they were greedy and fashioned themselves the gods of this world, and they turned their heads away.

Those in power did not care, and those without power could do nothing.

The only person who believed the Prophet Notor was this humble teacher Edon. When the Prophet Notor came to speak with me at Temple Zephon, which was old even when the world was young, he alone dared to listen and believe her. Edon was once amongst the star-kings of the Ergoad, abandoned by his father for his lack of ambition. The magic he knew was the magic of ship-building, of song-writing, of dancing, and of love. He did not have the magi's hunger. When the Prophet Notor came to him, he cast aside the gifts of his father and his people. There was not much time; the great wheel continued to turn against them.

The two teachers working together built a ship to the North overlooking the city of Ishana. The Prophet Notor was the most generous of teachers, and knew that as long as even a single spark of the Immortal Flame still burned, the miraculous proof of Ithax's creation still kept the hopes of its people lit. Edon built a lantern of bronze to store a mote of flame, and obtained a rare and

foreign oil to keep it lit. Lord Edon knew the flame meant nothing without the teachings of its prophets, that without knowledge the hearth is just a bonfire, and with the Prophet's help he transcribed the six Scriptures, the anti-Scripture, the Anagoge, and the Eschatology, some of which would become the foundation of the Orthodoxy today.

They loved each other with the love of Ithax and Ephris upon the sands.

Most ignored the construction of the ship. The magi laughed when they saw it from above. Only those without a home to welcome them took refuge amongst its iron rafters. They helped and they stole, those scoundrels, but even when wise Edon was driven into a fury, the Prophet Notor welcomed them. The ship was massive, as large as a Temple, and fueled by a furnace lit from the Immortal Flame. The two teachers crowded everything they could onto the ship, hoping to survive the calamity which every day grew near.

When the day came, and the great wheel turned, it was not enough. Nothing could have been enough.

When the world ended the ship was crushed against the mountain peak. Many died, much was lost. Many of the scriptures were washed away by the black tide. The dying world stripped everything from them. Lord Edon was left crippled and blind, the Prophet rendered mute.

When they emerged from the wreckage, they could not see or speak of the world they saw. The wreckage of the ship would serve as the foundation for Temple Notor, whose flame was lit when the Prophet gave her life to the fire to restore it. Edon would spend his days an eremite, isolated from society and dedicated to his recording of the past. More was forgotten than has ever been known.

When the world ended, a new world spun into its place. The first world was created by the hands of god, but its survival is determined by the patience and compassion of man.

Heresies & Other Faiths

Western Pyrism

Whenever you Spend Time with practitioners of Western Pyrism, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- Along the marshland north of the Druj, the cold people of Eofmark practice a form of flame-worship dedicated to the 11th Prophet, who they regard as the one true teacher, and dismiss the rest.
- Their greatest basilica is home to a flame they claim to be a branch of the Immortal Flames, and no Hierophant wishes to deny this and take away their spark of hope. Their basilica (Temple Dolmot) is smaller than the Temple Notor, and younger too.
- Many Eofmarkians perform long pilgrimages to Isha to witness the beauty of the temples for themselves, and the marketplaces of Ishana make a killing on their trade.

Urite Polytheism

Whenever you Spend Time with practitioners of Urite Polytheism, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Triarchy of Ur is a vast and spiritually multifaceted place, with enormous stone temples within every major city. These temples are allowed to host any number of idols, and the priests of Ur view themselves as caretakers of a vast pantheon, which varies from city to city.
- Within the enormous sprawling empire lives a thousand thousand different faiths, ranging from guttergods with trash idols to the great god-kings of the empire, whose tombs are massive idols which still somehow fit within the temples.
- There are a thousand thousand religions under the umbrella of Ur, including some branches of flame-worship, and some priests (falsely) claim to possess fragments of the Immortal Flame in the great city of Ur.

Hecarian Philosophism

Whenever you Spend Time with practitioners of Hecarian Philosophism, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Hecares Archipelago to the south of Isha holds to a variety of spiritual practices, all tethered by a shared investment in "philosophism," a way of life or approach to reason which serves as a bond between the different islands.
- Philosophism is characterized by an attachment to the material nature of objects shaped by their relationship to a higher plane of mathematical truths, known as the True Solids.

This includes a fondness for the mathematical perfection of a particular kind of male human body.

- Philosophism has been at times both outlawed and embraced by their Urite conquerors, with efforts historically made to integrate the two modes of perceiving the world. Now, with war on the horizon, the Boy-King Elpenor embraces a form of atheistic philosophism, condemning old gods as polytheistic intrusions onto a more "pure" Hecarian lifestyle.

Faith of the Nameless

Whenever you Spend Time with believers in the Nameless Faith, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The hrotingmen of Nebelheim worship dark and nameless gods, who are each dead from their own method of execution, who are venerated with blood and twisting steel.
- The greatest is known as None-Eyes, and other gods include the Hangman (who provides wisdom), the Flensed (a harvest god), and the Scaphist (who tends to their boats). They are called by their titles, for their true names were lost when they died.
- The Nameless Faith is taught by the wise-women of the hrotingmen, who claim that the gods were themselves killed by their greatest warriors during a great and powerful raid, and possess some artifacts of their death still.

Druji Pseudofaith

Whenever you Spend Time with "believers" of Drujite Pseudofaith, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Drujites are openly atheistic, and yet still engage in a complicated hierarchical religious practice, which they explain is dedicated to "the absence of a god."
- The Druj will build empty altars and abandoned temples, reciting ancient texts in their dense and necrotic tongue, and yet deny the presence of meaning — only the endless monotony of life and the escape of death.
- Drujite religion is inscrutable to outsiders (and some suspect intentionally so), its practice limited to their corpse-ports and the ghouls who adhere themselves to their creed. Despite this, anxieties about "drujite cults" have been used to justify religious violence.

Ymosites

Whenever you Spend Time with believers of Ymos, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Ymosites worship the gods who came before, the oldest gods of stone and moss, who sculpted Isha long before the Immortal Flames were lit. Their greatest deity is the Leviathan, who slumbers beneath the sea.
- The Ymosites are loathed in Isha, and accusations of their practice are a common method of smearing political rivals, but true Ymosite sects are present in the underbelly of Scuttleport, and on some of the furthest isles.
- Ymosian Cults are common among the sailors and witches of Scuttleport, for it is hard to go out and witness the awe of the sea and still trust a sputtering flame to aid you against the Leviathan.

Appendix

Names for the Common Folk

Men's Names

1. Jabbock
2. Marnitt
3. Shodge
4. Cor
5. Eol
6. Sheb
7. Orseck
8. Drennel
9. Crammick
10. Milleck
11. Sebesh
12. Eiles
13. Lemrick
14. Weyish
15. Beorn

16. Yosheb
17. Clordiff
18. Harny
19. Backlin
20. Nentough

Women's Names

1. Fosha
2. Liel
3. Eolsa
4. Vae
5. Eisol
6. Rasha
7. Limmie
8. Nara
9. Saida
10. Lalden
11. Noyanne
12. Sampe
13. Rachie
14. Denoff
15. Calma
16. Nayda
17. Leir
18. Halesh
19. Alshe
20. Cheslle

Peasant Surnames

1. Grazier
2. Millward
3. Tanner
4. Wainwright
5. Chanter
6. Barker

7. Carter
8. Barrister
9. Fisher
10. Coward
11. Currier
12. Hayward
13. Falkner
14. Elmen
15. Larimer
16. Piper
17. Messier
18. Sixsmith
19. Tavenner
20. Yeoman

Credits

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